

## MSI Wind U160MX

MSI announced an addition to its U100 series of netbooks with an ultra-slim 10.1-inch netbook which weighs only a kilogram with battery and promises over 8 hours of battery life

## Ovi store has Indian presence

Nokia and Reliance have come together to launch the Indian arm of the popular Ovi Store, with Reliance offering integrated billing for content bought from the Ovi Store

**Notebook test**

last years batch – it seems technology keeps getting more and more affordable.

For example, the Core i5 processor was something we never thought we'd see in a notebook priced below ₹40,000. Performance increments per clock and improved thermal performance mean that a Core i5 is faster than a Core 2 Duo at the same clock speed, while consuming less power. We're also quite pleased with the fact that manufacturers have finally upped the storage on the more affordable notebooks – 250 and 320 GB seems sufficient, but not when one uses a notebook as the primary means of entertainment – games, HD movie rips, and lossless music have a way of gobbling up drive space before you know it. We're also seeing 4 GB of RAM – which we feel should become de facto given the ultra affordable current pricing of DDR3 RAM. Which is why we were shocked with Zenith imbuing the Uranium with a very paltry 1 GB of memory. Multimedia demands more RAM – heck, Windows 7 demands more.

Which brings us to the usability quotient. It is nice to see the level of thought going into designing these notebooks.

Manufacturers have woken up to the fact that people spending 40,000 Rupees do not expect plain beige or grey briefcases. Neither do they expect shoddy and un-optimised keypads. Thankfully, for the most, these notebooks are all pretty usable, especially the Acer notebooks. ASUS too seems to have pulled up their socks with some functional and nice looking offerings.

As mentioned earlier, we've received notebooks from Dell and HCL that arrived after our deadlines for receiving products, and we didn't dare try delaying the magazine going for print, so these notebooks were skipped. However, we intend to review them online, and feature them alongside the tested models in an extended comparison from the one you just read. Stay tuned for the models within this category



Zenith Uranium has a good 14-inch screen but the build quality of its palm rest and trackpad is bad

that were missed this time. Additionally, we'll be doing a wider category of notebooks later on, in the year, which you might want to tune in to, especially if you're looking for something more upmarket. **d**

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